Sahara Desert Packing Checklist

Merzouga & Erg Chebbi tours — what to pack and what to leave behind

routeofthedunes.com

DOCUMENTS & MONEY

- Passport (valid 6+ months) — photocopy in a separate bag
- Travel insurance details saved offline
- Cash in MAD: small notes for souks, tips and restrooms
- Bank card + a backup card in a different bag

CLOTHING

- Long, loose layers — linen or cotton (days are hot, nights cold)
- Warm jacket or fleece (desert nights drop to 5°C in winter)
- Closed shoes or boots for sand dunes (sandals for the camp only)
- Sunglasses + scarf or shemagh for wind and sand
- Swimwear if your camp has a pool

CAMP & SLEEP

- Headlamp or small torch (camps are dark at night)
- Earplugs + eye mask for early sunrise departures
- Personal toiletries — camps provide basics but not brands you like
- Small day bag for the camel/4x4 ride to camp

HEALTH

- Sunscreen SPF 50+ and lip balm with SPF
- Personal medication + motion-sickness pills for Tizi n'Tichka pass
- Hand sanitiser and tissues for roadside stops
- Contact-lens supplies or spare glasses (dust is hard on lenses)

TECH

- Power bank — charging at camp is limited
- Universal adapter (Morocco uses EU two-pin plugs, 220V)
- Offline maps and bookings downloaded before the mountains

Tip: leave the hard-shell suitcase at your Marrakech riad — a soft duffel fits 4x4 roof racks better. Free printable checklist from routeofthedunes.com.